

GAYATRI REDDY, 20
KUDAL

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Manifesto for My Nation

My vision for the India of tomorrow is a land without violence and terror, where the youth are not compelled to take up a life of crime because of poverty. I dream of a country with safe borders so that our soldiers don't have to sacrifice their lives and stay away from their families on festivals.

I visualise a country which is safe for women so that parents don't have to pull their daughters back from achieving their dreams. Today, women match men in all professions but parents worry about their daughters being out till late. If we have a swift and stringent system of justice, crimes against women will reduce.

I want an India where every child can go to school, irrespective of poverty and geography. A country where everyone is valued and people aren't judged by their profession or social and economic status. ■

"I want an India without violence and terror, where women are safe and every child can go to school"

A Romantic Partner

For the most part of my life, I was a starry-eyed young girl who strongly believed that 'India is the best' and that it is progressing towards being a global superpower. While that is partly true, my education in development studies has given me a new outlook, a rather cynical one. So, I went from being blindly optimistic to openly pessimistic. And now I have a problem with everything. Or so I like to joke.

India is a land of diversity, culture, resources and has the potential to achieve greatness, but suffers setbacks in politics, policy implementation and mindsets. Nevertheless, I see a future for India where development is intersectional, depoliticised, constant, and, let's not forget, sustainable! One with a population above subsistence levels leading dignified lives. An India that is like a romantic partner: flexible, understanding and open to change. ■

"I see a future for India where development is intersectional, depoliticised, constant and sustainable"



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